



Planning Commission Meeting December 9th 2021

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3Cn_wzyoTD4
Publication Date	2021-12-10T00:12:29Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer called the meeting to order, noting mask-wearing precautions, and led attendees in the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:04](#). An administrative announcement was made noting that Adam Leach will replace Brian Stevens-Hotop as the new city engineer, effective at the January meeting [00:01:12](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Ms. Kerry, Mr. Dishman (President), Ms. Hensley, Ms. Sipe, and Mr. Wisely (plus roll call entries reflecting members present).
 - **Members Absent:** Mr. Hall (noted as absent/unable to attend during discussion), plus others unstated in the transcript text.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Mr. Dishman.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance led by Ricky [00:01:17](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** *Not mentioned in the transcript.*

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:01:32 New Business / Public Hearing: MPC08-21a <U+2013> Review of the Muncie Delaware County Comprehensive Plan ("Together DM")**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Marta (Planning Department / Planning Commission representative), joined by consultant team Pete Lombardi (Project Manager, CZB LLC), Thomas Eddington (CZB), and Matt Engels (Engels Design).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Marta provided background on the initiative to update the 20-year-old comprehensive plan in partnership with the Muncie Action Plan (MAP). Following a competitive RFP process involving 16 responses, CZB LLC and Engels Design were selected. Pete Lombardi presented core plan components, which include: defining community values (entrepreneurial, gritty, inclusive, bold, thoughtful); establishing the foundational direction of "getting the basics right"; prioritizing quality of place, housing conditions/options, and upward mobility; and outlining six place types (three for the city, three for the county).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Several members of the steering committee were acknowledged in the audience **00:13:57**. A general show of hands from supportive audience members favoring the plan was conducted **00:14:11**. Written input and suggestions were noted from absent board member J.P. Hall, Suzette Kitzelman (suggesting a vacancy tax), and Jane Ellery **00:15:05**. Marta read into the record six requested plan supplements/tweaks:
 1. Downtown infill improvements around the public square and county courthouse.
 2. Data and highlights on the "cradle to career" educational initiative.
 3. Statements recognizing ecological services and the protection of natural areas.
 4. Muncie Action Plan (MAP) background excerpts connecting to Together DM.
 5. Pandemic resilience impact and econometrics/quality of life (expanded to include both the City of Muncie and Delaware County per board member input).
 6. Identification of immediate 2-year implementation priorities.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Resolution 2021-08 (approving Together DM and forwarding a favorable recommendation to the County Commissioners and City Council) was motioned, seconded, and passed via a formal roll call vote of **6-0** (with 3 members absent) **00:22:12**.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *No general open public comment period or distinct citizen forum occurred outside of the formal public hearing item detailed above.*

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Favorable recommendations and resolutions of approval will be forwarded to the **Delaware County Commissioners** on January 3, 2022, at 9:00 AM at the County building [00:21:09](#).
 - Forwarded to the **City Council** on January 10, 2022, at 7:00 PM in the City Hall auditorium [00:20:41](#).
 - Updated plan materials will remain accessible via [togetherdm.com](#) and the plan commission's website [00:20:10](#).
- **Adjournment:** A motion to adjourn was made, seconded, and approved by roll call vote ([00:23:50](#)).

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